Teacher Guide & Answers

Passage Reading Level: Lexile 1030

1. **C** *Mars*

2. **A** *The cord connecting Roy to the spacecraft snaps.*

3. **C** *After his cord snaps, Roy saves himself by following the instructions that Ciara gives him.*

4. **B** *People on Earth are interested in the mission during takeoff and landing, but they lose interest in between.*

5. **D** *the excitement of discovery*

6. **B** *a launch that went exactly the way it was supposed to*

7. **A** *after*

8. **Suggested answer:** *(answers may vary but should resemble the following): Roy and Ciara Thomas are a married couple chosen by NASA for a mission to Mars.*

9. **Suggested answer:** *NASA chose Roy and Ciara for the Mars mission because they are intelligent, physically fit, and happily married.*

10. **Suggested answer:** *Answers may vary, as long as they are supported by the story. Students may argue that Roy and Ciara were a good choice for the Mars mission, citing such evidence as their ability to work together during the emergency of Roy's cord snapping. On the other hand, students may argue that Roy was not a good choice for the Mars mission, as he impulsively dashes forward after seeing something silver on Mars, causing the cord connecting him with the spacecraft to snap.*

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